

EDEXCEL INTERNATIONAL A LEVEL

WME01/01 January 2023 Worked Solutions

January 2023 paper rebuilt with the worked solution after each question.

8

paper questions

WME01

Mechanics 1

**Single-
paper
solutions**standalone IAL
route**Dr Eslam Ahmed**Prepared for Dr Eslam Ahmed - eliteigcse.com**M1**

PAST PAPER

WME01/01 January 2023

January 2023 | 8 questions | 75 marks

8

questions

75

marks

Answers

worked solution
after each
question

Question 1

Kinematics Graphs

1. A train travels along a straight horizontal track between two stations A and B .

The train starts from rest at station A and accelerates uniformly for T seconds until it reaches a speed of 20 ms^{-1} .

The train then travels at a constant speed of 20 ms^{-1} for 3 minutes before decelerating uniformly until it comes to rest at station B .

The magnitude of the acceleration of the train is twice the magnitude of the deceleration.

- (a) On the axes below, sketch a speed–time graph to illustrate the motion of the train as it moves from station A to station B .



If you need to redraw your graph, use the axes on page 3

(3)

Stations A and B are 4.8 km apart.

- (b) Find the value of T

(5)

- (c) Find the acceleration of the train during the first T seconds of its motion.

(2)

Only use these axes if you need to redraw your graph.



(Total for Question 1 is 10 marks)

Worked Solution - Question 1

1. Relate the acceleration and deceleration times

The train reaches 20 m s^{-1} in T seconds. Since the acceleration magnitude is twice the deceleration magnitude, the time needed to decelerate from 20 to 0 is $2T$.

2. Describe the graph

The speed-time graph rises linearly from $(0, 0)$ to $(T, 20)$, stays horizontal at speed 20 from T to $T + 180$, then falls linearly to zero at $3T + 180$.

3. Use area under the graph

The distance from A to B is $4.8 \text{ km} = 4800 \text{ m}$. The area is $\frac{1}{2}(T)(20) + 20(180) + \frac{1}{2}(2T)(20)$.

4. Solve for T

$4800 = 10T + 3600 + 20T$, so $1200 = 30T$ and $T = 40 \text{ s}$.

5. Find the acceleration

During the first T seconds, $20 = aT$. With $T = 40$, $a = \frac{20}{40} = 0.5 \text{ m s}^{-2}$.

Final answer

(a) Speed-time graph with times T , $T + 180$, $3T + 180$ and top speed 20

.

(b) $T = 40 \text{ s}$. (c) $a = 0.5 \text{ m s}^{-2}$.

Question 2

Momentum, Impulse & Collisions

2. Two particles, A and B , are moving in a straight line in opposite directions towards each other on a smooth horizontal surface when they collide directly.

Particle A has mass $3m$ kg and particle B has mass m kg.

Immediately before the collision, both particles have a speed of 1.5 ms^{-1}

Immediately after the collision, the direction of motion of A is unchanged and the difference between the speed of A and speed of B is 1 ms^{-1}

- (a) Find (i) the speed of A immediately after the collision,
(ii) the speed of B immediately after the collision.

(5)

- (b) Find, in terms of m , the magnitude of the impulse exerted on B in the collision.

(3)

Worked Solution - Question 2

Topic group

1. Choose a positive direction

Take the original direction of A as positive. Before the collision, A has velocity **1.5** and B has velocity **−1.5**.

2. Use the speed difference

After the collision, A keeps the same direction. Let A's speed be v . The valid motion has B moving in A's direction with speed $v + 1$.

3. Use conservation of momentum

$$3m(1.5) + m(-1.5) = 3mv + m(v + 1).$$

4. Find the two speeds

$4.5m - 1.5m = 3mv + mv + m$, so $3 = 4v + 1$. Hence $v = 0.5$, and B's speed is $v + 1 = 1.5$.

5. Find the impulse on B

For B, impulse equals change in momentum: $I = m(1.5 - (-1.5)) = 3m$.

6. State the magnitude

The magnitude of the impulse is $3m \text{ N s}$.

Final answer

(a)(i) speed of A = 0.5 m s^{-1} . (a)(ii) speed of B = 1.5 m s^{-1} . (b) $I = 3m \text{ N s}$.

Question 3

Working with Vectors

3. A particle P is moving with constant acceleration $(-4\mathbf{i} + \mathbf{j})\text{ms}^{-2}$

At time $t = 0$, P has velocity $(14\mathbf{i} - 5\mathbf{j})\text{ms}^{-1}$

- (a) Find the speed of P at time $t = 2$ seconds.

(3)

- (b) Find the size of the angle between the direction of $\mathbf{i}$ and the direction of motion of P at time $t = 2$ seconds.

(3)

At time $t = T$ seconds, P is moving in the direction of vector $(2\mathbf{i} - 3\mathbf{j})$

- (c) Find the value of T

(4)

Worked Solution - Question 3

1. Find the velocity at $t = 2$

$$\mathbf{v} = (14\mathbf{i} - 5\mathbf{j}) + 2(-4\mathbf{i} + \mathbf{j}) = 6\mathbf{i} - 3\mathbf{j}.$$

2. Find the speed

$$\text{The speed is } \sqrt{6^2 + (-3)^2} = \sqrt{45} = 3\sqrt{5} \text{ m s}^{-1}.$$

3. Find the angle with $\mathbf{i}$

The velocity $6\mathbf{i} - 3\mathbf{j}$ is below the positive $\mathbf{i}$ direction. The acute angle satisfies $\tan \theta = \frac{3}{6}$.

4. State the angle

$\theta = 26.6^\circ$, so the size of the angle is 27° to the nearest degree.

5. Write the velocity at time T

$$\mathbf{v}(T) = (14 - 4T)\mathbf{i} + (-5 + T)\mathbf{j}.$$

6. Use the given direction

The direction is parallel to $2\mathbf{i} - 3\mathbf{j}$, so the component ratio must match:

$$\frac{14 - 4T}{2} = \frac{-5 + T}{-3}.$$

7. Solve for T

$-3(14 - 4T) = 2(-5 + T)$, so $-42 + 12T = -10 + 2T$. Hence $10T = 32$ and $T = 3.2$.

Final answer

(a) $3\sqrt{5} \text{ m s}^{-1} \approx 6.7 \text{ m s}^{-1}$. (b) 27° . (c) $T = 3.2$.

Question 4

Moments

4.

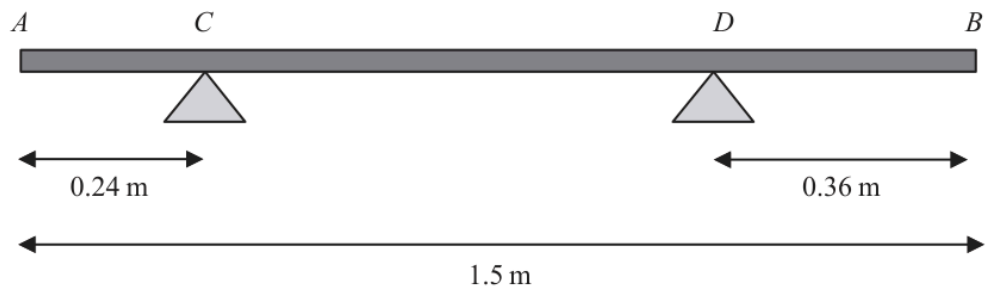


Figure 1

A branch AB , of length 1.5 m, rests horizontally in equilibrium on two supports.

The two supports are at the points C and D , where $AC = 0.24$ m and $DB = 0.36$ m, as shown in Figure 1.

When a force of 150 N is applied vertically upwards at B , the branch is on the point of tilting about C .

When a force of 225 N is applied vertically downwards at B , the branch is on the point of tilting about D .

The branch is modelled as a non-uniform rod AB of weight W newtons.

The distance from the point C to the centre of mass of the rod is x metres.

Use the model to find

- (i) the value of W
- (ii) the value of x

(8)

Worked Solution - Question 4

1. Set the distances

The branch has length 1.5 m. Since $AC = 0.24$ m and $DB = 0.36$ m, $CB = 1.26$ m and $CD = 0.90$ m. The centre of mass is x m from C.

2. Use the first tilting condition

With the 150 N upward force at B, the branch is on the point of tilting about C, so the support at D has zero reaction.

3. Take moments about C

The upward force at B balances the weight moment: $150(1.26) = Wx$. Thus $Wx = 189$.

4. Use the second tilting condition

With the 225 N downward force at B, the branch is on the point of tilting about D, so the support at C has zero reaction.

5. Take moments about D

The distance from D to the centre of mass is $0.90 - x$. Hence $225(0.36) = W(0.90 - x)$.

6. Solve the simultaneous equations

From the second equation, $81 = 0.90W - Wx$. Since $Wx = 189$, $81 = 0.90W - 189$, so $0.90W = 270$ and $W = 300$ N.

7. Find x

Using $Wx = 189$, $300x = 189$, so $x = 0.63$ m.

Final answer

(i) $W = 300 \text{ N}$. (ii) $x = 0.63 \text{ m}$.

Question 5

Constant Acceleration in 1D



Figure 2

Three points P , Q and R are on a horizontal road where PQR is a straight line.

The point Q is between P and R , with $PQ = 6x$ metres and $QR = 5x$ metres, as shown in Figure 2.

A vehicle moves along the road from P to Q with constant acceleration.

The vehicle is modelled as a particle.

At time $t = 0$, the vehicle passes P with speed $u \text{ m s}^{-1}$

At time $t = 12 \text{ s}$, the vehicle passes Q with speed $2u \text{ m s}^{-1}$

Using the model,

(a) show that $x = 3u$

(2)

As the vehicle passes Q , the acceleration of the vehicle changes instantaneously to 1.5 m s^{-2}

The vehicle continues to move with a constant acceleration of 1.5 m s^{-2} and passes R with speed $3u \text{ m s}^{-1}$

Using the model,

(b) find the value of u ,

(3)

(c) find the distance travelled by the vehicle during the first 14 seconds after passing P

(4)

Worked Solution - Question 5

Topic group

1. Use average speed from P to Q

From P to Q, the speed changes uniformly from u to $2u$ over 12 s. The average speed is $\frac{u + 2u}{2} = \frac{3u}{2}$.

2. Show $x = 3u$

Distance $PQ = 6x$, so $6x = \frac{3u}{2} \cdot 12 = 18u$. Hence $x = 3u$.

3. Use Q to R

The distance $QR = 5x = 15u$. The speed changes from $2u$ to $3u$ with acceleration 1.5 m s^{-2} .

4. Find u

Use $v^2 = u^2 + 2as$: $(3u)^2 = (2u)^2 + 2(1.5)(15u)$. Thus $9u^2 = 4u^2 + 45u$, so $5u^2 = 45u$ and $u = 9$.

5. Find the first 12 seconds distance

In the first 12 seconds, the distance is $PQ = 6x = 18u = 18(9) = 162 \text{ m}$.

6. Find the next 2 seconds distance

From $t = 12$ to $t = 14$, the vehicle starts this part at speed $2u = 18$ and accelerates at 1.5. Distance $= 18(2) + \frac{1}{2}(1.5)(2^2) = 36 + 3 = 39 \text{ m}$.

7. Add the distances

Total distance in the first 14 seconds is $162 + 39 = 201 \text{ m}$.

Final answer

(a) $x = 3u$. (b) $u = 9$. (c) 201 m.

Question 6

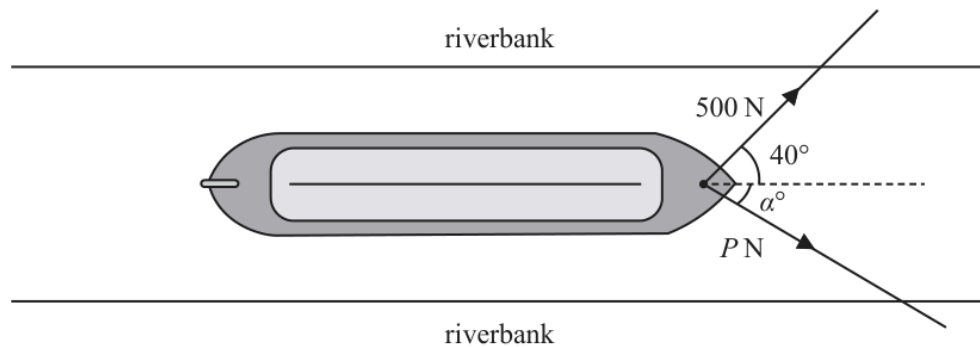


Figure 3

A boat is pulled along a river at a constant speed by two ropes.

The banks of the river are parallel and the boat travels horizontally in a straight line, parallel to the riverbanks.

- The tension in the first rope is 500 N acting at an angle of 40° to the direction of motion, as shown in Figure 3.
- The tension in the second rope is P newtons, acting at an angle of α° to the direction of motion, also shown in Figure 3.
- The resistance to motion of the boat as it moves through the water is a constant force of magnitude 900 N

The boat is modelled as a particle. The ropes are modelled as being light and lying in a horizontal plane.

Use the model to find

- the value of α
- the value of P

(8)

Worked Solution - Question 6

Topic group

1. Resolve perpendicular to the motion

The boat travels straight, so the sideways components balance:

$$500 \sin 40^\circ = P \sin \alpha.$$

2. Resolve along the motion

The speed is constant, so the forward components balance the resistance:

$$500 \cos 40^\circ + P \cos \alpha = 900.$$

3. Eliminate P

From the two equations, $P \sin \alpha = 500 \sin 40^\circ$ and

$$P \cos \alpha = 900 - 500 \cos 40^\circ.$$

4. Find alpha

Divide the sine equation by the cosine equation: $\tan \alpha = \frac{500 \sin 40^\circ}{900 - 500 \cos 40^\circ}.$

This gives $\alpha = 31.9^\circ$, so $\alpha = 32^\circ$ approximately.

5. Find P

Use $P \sin \alpha = 500 \sin 40^\circ$: $P = \frac{500 \sin 40^\circ}{\sin 31.9^\circ} = 608.7 \dots \text{ N}$. Hence $P \approx 610 \text{ N}$.

Final answer

(i) $\alpha = 32^\circ$ approximately. (ii) $P = 610 \text{ N}$ approximately.

Question 7

Newton's Second Law

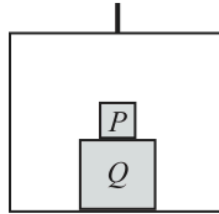


Figure 4

A simple lift operates by means of a vertical cable which is attached to the top of the lift.

The lift has mass m

A box Q is placed on the floor of the lift.

A box P is placed directly on top of box Q , as shown in Figure 4.

The cable is modelled as being light and inextensible and air resistance is modelled as being negligible.

The tension in the cable is $\frac{42mg}{5}$

The lift and its contents move vertically upwards with acceleration $\frac{2g}{5}$

Using the model,

- (a) find, in terms of m , the combined mass of boxes P and Q

(4)

During the motion of the lift, the force exerted on box P by box Q is $\frac{14mg}{5}$

Using the model,

- (b) find, in terms of m , the mass of box P

(3)

Worked Solution - Question 7

1. Define the box mass

Let the combined mass of boxes P and Q be M . The lift itself has mass m , so the total moving mass is $m + M$.

2. Apply Newtons second law to the whole system

Taking upward as positive, $\frac{42}{5}mg - (m + M)g = (m + M)\frac{2g}{5}$.

3. Find M

Move the weight term to the right:

$\frac{42}{5}mg = (m + M)\left(g + \frac{2g}{5}\right) = \frac{7g}{5}(m + M)$. Hence $42m = 7(m + M)$ and $M = 5m$.

4. Let the mass of P be p

For box P alone, the upward force from Q is $\frac{14}{5}mg$, while its weight is pg . The acceleration is still $\frac{2g}{5}$ upward.

5. Apply Newtons second law to P

$$\frac{14}{5}mg - pg = p\frac{2g}{5}.$$

6. Find p

Divide by g : $\frac{14}{5}m = p + \frac{2p}{5} = \frac{7p}{5}$. Therefore $p = 2m$.

Final answer

(a) combined mass of P and Q = $5m$. (b) mass of P = $2m$.

Question 8

Resolving Forces, Inclined Planes

8.

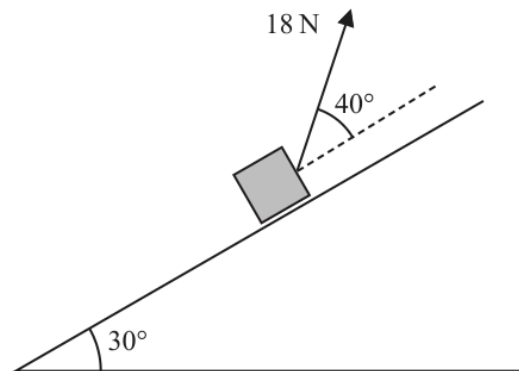


Figure 5

A parcel of mass 2 kg is pulled up a rough inclined plane by the action of a constant force.

The force has magnitude 18 N and acts at an angle of 40° to the plane.

The line of action of the force lies in a vertical plane containing a line of greatest slope of the inclined plane.

The plane is inclined at an angle of 30° to the horizontal, as shown in Figure 5.

The coefficient of friction between the plane and the parcel is 0.3

The parcel is modelled as a particle P

(a) Find the acceleration of P

(8)

The points A and B lie on a line of greatest slope of the plane, where $AB = 5$ m and B is above A . Particle P passes through A with speed 2 m s^{-1} in the direction AB .

(b) Find the speed of P as it passes through B .

(3)

The force of 18 N is removed at the instant P passes through B . As a result, P comes to rest at the point C .

(c) Determine whether P will remain at rest at C . You must show all stages of your working clearly.

(4)

Worked Solution - Question 8

Topic group

1. Resolve perpendicular to the plane

The force of 18 N is angled away from the plane, so $R + 18 \sin 40^\circ = 2g \cos 30^\circ$.
Hence $R = 2g \cos 30^\circ - 18 \sin 40^\circ$.

2. Use friction

The parcel moves up the plane, so friction acts down the plane. With $\mu = 0.3$,
 $F = 0.3R$.

3. Resolve parallel to the plane

Taking up the plane as positive: $18 \cos 40^\circ - F - 2g \sin 30^\circ = 2a$.

4. Substitute for R and F

$$18 \cos 40^\circ - 0.3(2g \cos 30^\circ - 18 \sin 40^\circ) - 2g \sin 30^\circ = 2a.$$

5. Find the acceleration

Using $g = 9.8$, this gives $a = 1.18 \dots \text{ m s}^{-2}$ up the plane.

6. Find the speed at B

From A to B, $u = 2$, $s = 5$ and $a = 1.18 \dots$. Use $v^2 = u^2 + 2as$:
 $v^2 = 2^2 + 2(1.18 \dots)(5)$.

7. State the speed

$$v = 3.98 \dots \text{ m s}^{-1}, \text{ about } 4.0 \text{ m s}^{-1}.$$

8. Check rest after the force is removed

At C, with the pulling force removed, $R = 2g \cos 30^\circ$. The maximum friction is
 $0.3R = 0.3(2g \cos 30^\circ) = 5.09 \dots \text{ N}$.

9. Compare with the downslope weight component

The component of weight down the plane is $2g \sin 30^\circ = 9.8 \text{ N}$. Since $9.8 > 5.09 \dots$, friction is not large enough to hold P at rest, so P will not remain at rest at C.

Final answer

(a) $a = 1.18 \text{ m s}^{-2}$ up the plane. (b) $v = 3.98 \text{ m s}^{-1} \approx 4.0 \text{ m s}^{-1}$. (c)
P will not remain at rest at C.